Online Appendix for *China Visits*

1 Data Collection

We use five different sources to collect data on leader visits: (1) leader-based summaries of foreign visits, (2) year-based leaders' foreign visits, (3) summary of China's bilateral relations (4) keyword-based Google search and (5) Wikipedia pages on leaders' foreign visits. These sources complement and corroborate each other. In the following, we describe how we utilize each source.

Leader-Based Collections of Visits: Leader-based collections are official reports on leaders' foreign visits. We are able to find such collections for all six leaders. These reports are authoritative as they are from official websites, such as xinhuanet.com and people.com.cn. A limitation of these reports is that they do not cover the entire period when the leaders are in office. In Table 1, we describe the sources for all the leaders between 1998 and 2020.

Table 1: Leader-Based Collection: Sources for Each Leader

Leader	Source	Coverage
Pres. Jiang	www.people.com.cn/GB/shizheng/252/2140/2840/index1.html	2001-2002
Premier Zhu	www.xinhuanet.com/newscenter/ldrbdzj/chufang_zhurj.htm	1998-2002
Pres. Hu	www.xinhuanet.com/politics/leaders/hujintao/cf.htm	2011-2012
Pres. Hu	peopledaily.com.cn/GB/shizheng/252/2152/2902/index1.html	2003-2004
Premier Wen	www.xinhuanet.com/newscenter/ldrbdzj/wjb2003_chufang.htm	2003-2007
Pres. Xi	cpc.people.com.cn/GB/64192/105996/352006/index1.html	2019-2020
Premier Li	cpc.people.com.cn/GB/64192/106023/352014/index.html	2018-2019

Year-Based Collection of Visits: Year-based collections come from China's Ministry of Foreign Affairs: https://www.fmprc.gov.cn/web/ziliao_674904/zt_674979/ywzt_675099. They are neatly grouped on a yearly basis and cover the period between 2000 and 2019. *Summary of China's Bilateral Relations:* The website of China's Foreign Ministry provides a summary of China's bilateral relations with each country that it has diplomatic ties with: www.fmprc.gov.cn/web/gjhdq_676201/gj_676203/yz_676205/. These summaries typically, but not always, include an exhaustive list of visits by the president and the premier.

Keyword-Based Collection of Visits: As our fourth source, we search for reports on leader visits using Google in both English and Chinese. We list the keywords that we used in Table 2. We use these keywords to search for visits that took place in a given year, e.g. 2011, 2012, 2013.

Table 2: Keywords for Collecting Reports on Leader Visits

English	Chinese
President Jiang, visit	江泽民, 访问
Premier Zhu, visit	朱镕基, 访问
President Hu, visit	胡锦涛, 访问
Premier Wen, visit	温家宝, 访问
President Xi, visit	习近平, 访问
Premier Li, visit	李克强, 访问

Wikipedia-Based Collection of Visits: There is a dedicated Wikipedia page for each leader. We list them in Table 3.

Table 3: Wikipedia Sources for Leader Visits

Leader	Source
President Xi	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_international_trips_made_by_Xi_Jinping
Premier Li	zh.wikipedia.org/wiki/李克强外交访问列表
President Hu	zh.wikipedia.org/wiki/胡锦涛外事访问列表
Premier Wen	zh.wikipedia.org/wiki/温家宝外交访问列表
President Jiang	zh.wikipedia.org/wiki/江泽民外事访问列表
Premier Zhu	zh.wikipedia.org/wiki/朱镕基外交访问列表

2 Quality Checks

2.1 Quality Check: Comparison with Kastner & Saunders (2012)

Table 4 lists the cases where our records differ from those in Kastner & Saunders (2012). In Column 1, we list the country name. In Columns 2 and 4, we list the number of visits by Kastner & Saunders (2012). Column 2 counts extended meetings as visits whereas Column 4 does not. In Column 3, we list the number of visits based on our dataset. In the ideal case, our number should lie between Column 2 and Column 4.

Table 4: Cases where our records differ from Kastner & Saunders (2012) by administration

Country	Visits, including extended meetings	Ours	Visits, excluding extended meetings	Period
Russia	7	4	5	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
United States	4	2	4	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Luxembourg	3	1	3	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Australia	2	1	2	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Canada	2	1	2	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Egypt	2	1	2	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
France	2	3	2	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Mongolia	2	1	2	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Netherlands	2	1	2	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Kyrgyzstan	1	0	1	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Mexico	1	0	1	Jiang-Zhu (1998-2003)
Canada	3	2	3	Hu-Wen (2003-2008)
Portugal	2	1	2	Hu-Wen (2003-2008)
Spain	2	1	2	Hu-Wen (2003-2008)
Laos	2	3	1	Hu-Wen (2003-2008)
United Arab Emirates	1	0	1	Hu-Wen (2003-2008)
Liberia	0	1	0	Hu-Wen (2003-2008)

Regarding the differences reported in Table 4, our numbers for visits to the U.S., Luxembourg, Australia, Canada, Mongolia, and Mexico are supported by data in China's Ministry of Foreign Affairs.[26] For Egypt, we have documents that confirm Premier Zhu visited Egypt once and President Jiang did not visit Egypt between 1998 and 2002.[27] For both Russia and Netherlands, we do record one extra visit in 1998, but these visits were by Premier Li Peng, who was succeeded by Premier Zhu in the same year. For Kyrgyzstan, we could not find any record on leader visits between 1998 and 2002. For France, President Jiang visited once in 1999 and Premier Zhu visited twice in 1998 and 2002 respectively. For detailed records, please see the supporting documents in our dataset.

We differ from Kastner & Saunders (2012) for six countries between 2003 and 2008. For Canada, there was one presidential visit in 2005 and one premier visit in 2003.[28] For Portugal, President Hu made his first visit in 2010.[29] Per our dataset, Premier Wen only visited once in 2005. For Spain, President Hu made his visit in 2005 and the next presidential visit did not took place until 13 years later in 2018.[30] Premier Wen made the first premier visit to Spain in 17 years.[31] For UAE, Premier Wen made the first premier visit to UAE in 2012 and President Hu never visited UAE.[32] For Laos and Liberia, please see the supporting documents in our dataset.

2.2 Quality Check: Comparison with Lin et al. (2017)

Table 5: Cumulative Number of Leader Visits to Africa

Period	President		Premier	
	Lin et al. (2017)	Ours	Lin et al. (2017)	Ours
2001-2005	6	6	5	7
2006-2012	16	15	9	8

[26] See https://www.fmprc.gov.cn/web/gjhdq_676201/gj_676203/yz_676205/.

[27] See https://www.fmprc.gov.cn/ce/ceegy/chn/zaigx/zzgx/zrjzl/t94367.htm for Premier Zhu's visit to Egypt and http://www.chinanews.com/gn/2013/03-24/4670928.shtml for a record of President Jiang's visit to Africa.

[28] Please see https://www.fmprc.gov.cn/web/gjhdq_676201/gj_676203/bmz_679954/1206_680426/sbgx_680430/

[29] http://www.chinanews.com/gn/2010/11-06/2639015.shtml.

[30] For President Hu's visit to Spain, see https://www.fmprc.gov.cn/ce/ceat/chn/xwdt/t221611.htm. For President Xi's visit, see http://www.chinanews.com/gn/2018/11-28/8687726.shtml.

[31] https://www.fmprc.gov.cn/web/wjbxw_673019/t533499.shtml.

[32] For Premier Wen's visit, see http://www.chinanews.com/gn/2012/01-16/3607602.shtml. President Xi was the first Chinese president to visit the UAE in the 21st century. See http://world.people.com.cn/n1/2018/0718/c1002-30154803.html.

Between 2006 and 2012, we recorded 15 state visits to Africa by the Chinese president, while Lin et al. (2017) recorded 16. We recorded 8 formal visits by the Chinese premier and Lin et al. (2017) recorded 9. Our records are supported by the official summary at http://www.gov.cn/xinwen/2014-05/04/content_2671090.htm.

2.3 Quality Check: Comparison with McManus (2018)

Table 6: Presidential Visits between 1998 and 2006

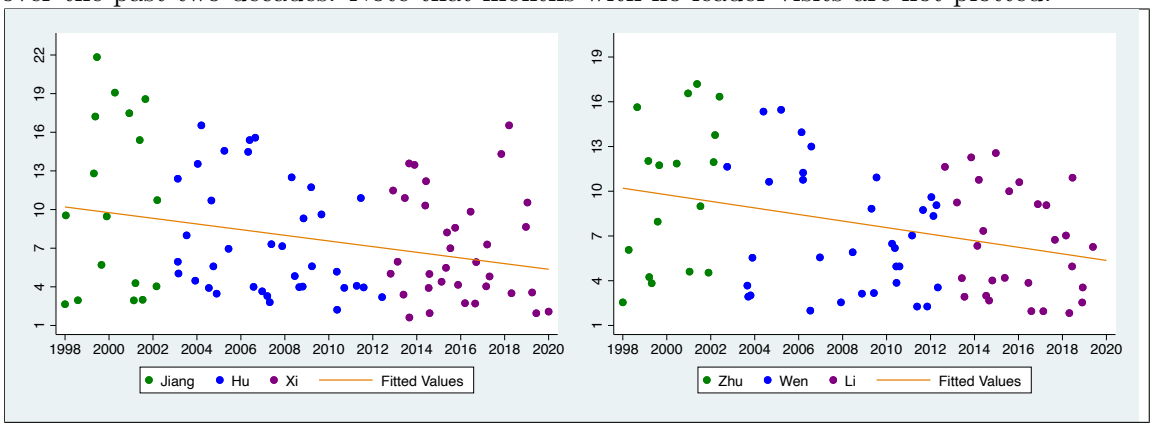
Visits that we missed			Visits that McManus missed		
Year	Country	Reason	Year	Country	Reason
1998	Malaysia	APEC	2000	Brunei	State visit
1999	Kyrgyzstan	Shanghai Five	2001	Malta	State visit
2002	Kazakhstan	CICA	2001	Ukraine	State visit
2002	Mexico	APEC	2002	Iceland	State visit
2003	France	North-South Dialogue	2005	Brunei	State visit
2006	Kazakhstan	CICA			

CICA: Conference on Interaction and Confidence-Building Measures in Asia

North-South Dialogue: Leaders' Informal Dialogue Meeting between the North and the South

3 Additional Figures

Figure 1: Duration Distribution of Chinese Leader Visits between 1998 and 2020: the total number of days per month spent visiting abroad by the Chinese leaders has been decreasing over the past two decades. Note that months with no leader visits are not plotted.



4 Summary Statistics

Table 7: Countries that Broke Ties with Taiwan between 1998 and 2019.

Country	Breaking Ties with Taiwan
Kiribati, Solomon Islands	2019
Burkina Faso, Dominican Republic, El Salvador	2018
Panama	2017
São Tomé and Príncipe	2016
Gambia	2013
Malawi	2008
Costa Rica	2007
Chad	2006
Grenada, Senegal	2005
Dominica, Vanuatu	2004
Liberia	2003
Macedonia	2001
Central African Republic, South Africa, Tonga	1998

Table 8: Descriptive Statistics

	Mean	Min	Max	SD	Count
Presidential Visit	0.06	0.00	1.00	0.24	3681
Premier Visit	0.05	0.00	1.00	0.22	3681
Log(Population)	15.73	10.19	21.03	1.99	3645
Log(GDP per capita)	8.35	4.51	12.15	1.64	3577
GDP Growth	0.00	-0.06	0.15	0.01	3554
Resources	0.08	0.00	0.87	0.12	3546
Log(Distance)	8.95	6.70	9.87	0.52	3681
Major Power	0.04	0.00	1.00	0.19	3681
Japan	0.01	0.00	1.00	0.08	3681
Polity	0.04	-0.10	0.10	0.06	3217
UNGA Voting	0.72	0.07	1.00	0.16	3605
Meeting with Dalai	0.01	0.00	1.00	0.11	3681
SCO	0.03	0.00	1.00	0.16	3681
ASEAN	0.02	0.00	1.00	0.15	3681

Table 9: Correlations between Dependent Variables and Independent Variables

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)	(13)	(14)
(1) Presidential Visit	1.00													
(2) Premier Visit	-0.03	1.00												
(3) Log(Population)	0.14	0.17	1.00											
(4) Log(GDP per capita)	0.06	0.09	-0.09	1.00										
(5) GDP Growth	0.02	-0.01	-0.01	-0.13	1.00									
(6) Resources	-0.02	-0.05	-0.07	-0.16	0.15	1.00								
(7) Log(Distance)	-0.08	-0.14	-0.17	-0.02	-0.10	0.05	1.00							
(8) Major Power	0.13	0.19	0.32	0.26	-0.07	-0.10	-0.08	1.00						
(9) Japan	0.01	0.04	0.14	0.12	-0.05	-0.06	-0.22	0.40	1.00					
(10) Polity	-0.00	0.05	0.02	0.35	-0.13	-0.52	0.16	0.17	0.08	1.00				
(11) UNGA Voting	-0.02	-0.05	-0.01	-0.54	0.15	0.41	0.04	-0.32	-0.08	-0.52	1.00			
(12) Meeting with Dalai	0.01	-0.01	0.08	0.12	-0.00	-0.08	0.02	0.17	-0.01	0.10	-0.19	1.00		
(13) SCO	0.17	0.12	0.15	-0.08	0.06	0.04	-0.23	0.11	-0.02	-0.11	0.09	-0.01	1.00	
(14) ASEAN	0.03	0.09	0.13	-0.00	0.06	-0.05	-0.26	-0.03	-0.01	-0.07	0.09	-0.02	-0.03	1.00

5 Additional Results

Table 10: Determinants of Chinese Leader Visits: OLS and Bivariate Probit

	OLS		Bivariate Probit	
	President	Premier	President	Premier
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Log(Population)	0.02***	0.02***	0.15***	0.20***
	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.03)	(0.03)
Log(GDP per capita)	0.02***	0.02***	0.17***	0.21***
	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.03)	(0.04)
GDP Growth	0.91	-0.13	11.08	1.94
	(0.75)	(0.55)	(8.00)	(10.43)
Resources	-0.04	-0.05	-0.60	-0.69
	(0.05)	(0.04)	(0.43)	(0.49)
Log(Distance)	-0.01	-0.05***	-0.09	-0.41***
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.08)	(0.08)
Major Power	0.12***	0.19***	0.47**	0.78***
	(0.04)	(0.06)	(0.18)	(0.18)
Japan	-0.21***	-0.18***	-1.23**	-1.28***
	(0.04)	(0.06)	(0.52)	(0.39)
Polity	-0.03	0.19***	-0.65	0.56
	(0.12)	(0.07)	(0.83)	(0.93)
UNGA Voting	0.09**	0.10**	0.78**	0.79*
	(0.03)	(0.04)	(0.37)	(0.41)
Meeting with Dalai	-0.04	-0.11***	-0.30	-1.09**
	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.30)	(0.47)
SCO	0.22***	0.12***	1.05***	0.67***
	(0.07)	(0.02)	(0.17)	(0.18)
ASEAN	0.03	0.10***	0.22	0.52***
	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.22)	(0.20)
Presidential Visit (t-1)	-0.11***	-0.02	-1.09***	-0.26
	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.24)	(0.16)
Premier Visit (t-1)	0.04	-0.11***	0.15	-0.88***
	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.14)	(0.20)
Observations	2944	2944	2944	2944
R^2	0.080	0.102	-	-

Standard errors in parentheses
Constant is included in the regressions but not reported
ρ in bivariate probit is -0.43 with a standard error of 0.09
* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table 11: Determinants of Leader Visits: Dropping Polity Score

	Probit		OLS		Bivariate Probit	
	President	Premier	President	Premier	President	Premier
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Log(Population)	0.16***	0.21***	0.02***	0.02***	0.15***	0.21***
	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.02)	(0.03)
Log(GDP per capita)	0.18***	0.22***	0.02***	0.02***	0.18***	0.21***
	(0.03)	(0.04)	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.03)	(0.04)
GDP Growth	12.75*	-0.16	0.96	-0.26	12.57*	-0.57
	(6.79)	(7.85)	(0.71)	(0.50)	(7.44)	(10.10)
Resources	-0.36	-0.76*	-0.03	-0.08**	-0.38	-0.70*
	(0.50)	(0.44)	(0.05)	(0.03)	(0.37)	(0.42)
Log(Distance)	-0.13	-0.41***	-0.01	-0.04***	-0.13*	-0.40***
	(0.09)	(0.08)	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.08)	(0.08)
Major Power	0.47***	0.73***	0.12***	0.19***	0.48***	0.77***
	(0.18)	(0.25)	(0.04)	(0.06)	(0.18)	(0.18)
Japan	-1.31***	-1.23***	-0.21***	-0.17**	-1.29**	-1.25***
	(0.17)	(0.25)	(0.04)	(0.06)	(0.52)	(0.39)
UNGA Voting	0.89***	0.69*	0.08***	0.06*	0.92***	0.68*
	(0.29)	(0.36)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.33)	(0.37)
Meeting with Dalai	-0.29	-1.08***	-0.04	-0.11***	-0.29	-1.11**
	(0.23)	(0.33)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.30)	(0.48)
SCO	1.08***	0.72***	0.22***	0.12***	1.05***	0.68***
	(0.30)	(0.18)	(0.07)	(0.02)	(0.17)	(0.18)
ASEAN	0.23	0.58***	0.03	0.11***	0.24	0.59***
	(0.18)	(0.18)	(0.03)	(0.03)	(0.21)	(0.19)
Presidential Visit (t-1)	-1.14***	-0.25	-0.11***	-0.02	-1.10***	-0.26*
	(0.33)	(0.17)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.24)	(0.16)
Premier Visit (t-1)	0.12	-0.93***	0.03	-0.11***	0.13	-0.89***
	(0.13)	(0.22)	(0.03)	(0.02)	(0.14)	(0.20)
Observations	3339	3339	3339	3339	3339	3339
(Pseudo) R^2	0.145	0.206	0.080	0.103	-	-

Standard errors in parentheses

Constant is included in the regressions but not reported

Pseudo R^2 for probit, R^2 for OLS, ρ in bivariate probit is -0.43 with a standard error of 0.09

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

Table 12: Dalai Lama Visits: Country Fixed Effects

	Conditional Logit		OLS	
	President	Premier	President	Premier
Log(Population)	1.10	-0.05	0.05	0.03
	(1.00)	(1.20)	(0.03)	(0.04)
Log(GDP per capita)	0.11	0.76***	0.01	0.04**
	(0.33)	(0.28)	(0.02)	(0.02)
GDP Growth	17.03	-23.43	1.21	-0.40
	(11.71)	(33.58)	(0.84)	(0.59)
Resources	-1.83	4.35**	-0.08	0.14**
	(2.04)	(1.69)	(0.09)	(0.06)
Polity	2.13	1.36	0.16	0.14
	(4.43)	(3.01)	(0.23)	(0.16)
UNGA Voting	1.06	1.70	0.05	0.07
	(1.20)	(1.91)	(0.07)	(0.09)
Meeting with Dalai	-0.30	-2.08*	-0.03	-0.09***
	(0.48)	(1.13)	(0.04)	(0.04)
Presidential Visit (t-1)	-3.06***	-0.66**	-0.17***	-0.04*
	(0.76)	(0.33)	(0.03)	(0.02)
Premier Visit (t-1)	0.12	-2.30***	0.02	-0.16***
	(0.24)	(0.36)	(0.03)	(0.02)
Year Fixed Effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Country Fixed Effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	1929	1637	2944	2944
(Pseudo) R^2	0.097	0.111	0.135	0.154

Standard errors in parentheses

Constant is included in OLS but not reported

Pseudo R^2 for conditional logit, R^2 for OLS

* $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$